

EIC SCHOOL · ADULT B2+ · PART 1 OF 2

The Invisible Hand

Causative verbs & passive voice

Read the text once. Then build your questions from the sentences below.

Student name

Date

THE TEXT

Read once before building your questions.

Every morning, before Nara opens her eyes, the algorithm has already had her feed curated. By the time she reaches for her phone, a version of the world has been assembled for her: the products she is likely to want, the opinions she is likely to find persuasive, the people whose lives will make her feel behind. She did not ask for this. She does not refuse it either.

The system does not make Nara do anything in the way that a command does. It works more quietly than that. It gets her to want things she did not know she lacked. A bag she never needed becomes, after fourteen impressions, something she feels she has been missing. Her desire has been manufactured for her so smoothly that the manufacturing is invisible.

Bernays understood this a hundred years ago. He got an entire generation to associate cigarettes with freedom. He did not lie, exactly. He simply placed the right objects in the hands of the right people and let the public believe that the desire was their own. The technique has not changed. Only the medium has.

Huxley saw the endpoint. In his World State, citizens are not forced into happiness — they have their happiness designed for them before they are born. The conditioning is so complete that the question of freedom never arises. Soma makes them feel exactly what the system needs them to feel. No one refuses. There is nothing to refuse against.

This is what Zuboff calls behavioural modification at scale. The platform does not punish the wrong choices — it makes the wrong choices seem unthinkable. It gets you to stay not through walls but through a variable reward schedule that your nervous system was never designed to resist.

Nara has never thought of herself as someone who lets the system decide what she wants. She thinks of herself as someone with taste, with preferences, with a carefully considered sense of who she is. And she is right, in a way. The preferences are real. The question is only: who had them designed?

A cage that makes you love it is still a cage. It is simply a better one.

CAUSATIVE QUESTIONS

Build the question from the sentence.**01** HAVE SOMETHING DONE

The algorithm has already had her _____ curated before Nara opens her eyes.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

02 GET + TO + INFINITIVE

The system gets her to want things she _____ them — she did not know she lacked them.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

03 GET + TO + INFINITIVE

Bernays got an entire generation to associate cigarettes with _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

04 LET + BARE INFINITIVE

Bernays let the public believe _____ — that it was their own.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

05 HAVE SOMETHING DONE

Citizens have their happiness designed for them _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

06 GET + TO + INFINITIVE

The platform gets you to stay not through walls but through _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

07 LET + BARE INFINITIVE

Nara lets the system decide _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

08 HAVE SOMETHING DONE

The text ends with a question: who had _____ designed?

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

PASSIVE VOICE QUESTIONS

Focus on the agent that disappears.

01 PRESENT PERFECT PASSIVE

A version of the world has been assembled for _____ before she opens her eyes.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

02 PRESENT PERFECT PASSIVE

Her desire has been manufactured for her so _____ that the manufacturing is invisible.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

03 PRESENT SIMPLE PASSIVE

Citizens are not forced into _____ — they have their happiness designed for them instead.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

04 PAST SIMPLE PASSIVE

Your nervous system was never designed _____.

Your question Who / What / When / Why / How...?

BEFORE PART TWO

Five questions of concept.

No correct answer. Take a position and defend it.

01 Is desire that was engineered still genuine — or does its origin change what it is?

Frankfurt / Huxley

Frankfurt argues that a desire is genuinely yours if you reflectively endorse it — if you want to want it — regardless of its origin. Huxley's counter: if the capacity for reflection was itself engineered, the endorsement collapses.

02 The text argues the system works through persuasion, not force. Does that distinction matter morally?

Bernays / Huxley

Bernays believed engineering consent was more democratic than coercion. Huxley thought this was the most dangerous illusion: a cage that persuades you to enter is harder to escape than one that traps you.

03 Huxley's citizens are designed to love what the system needs them to love. Is that freedom, or its opposite?

Huxley — *Brave New World Revisited* (1958)

In his 1958 follow-up, Huxley argued that the most insidious tyranny feels like contentment. John the Savage refuses engineered happiness. Huxley treats that refusal as the only authentically human choice available.

04 If resistance always gets absorbed by the system — turned into a brand, a lifestyle, a market — does that mean resistance is pointless?

Mark Fisher — *Capitalist Realism* (2009)

Fisher described capitalism as infinitely plastic, capable of absorbing anything. Punk becomes a clothing line. He did not conclude resistance was pointless — only that it must operate at the level of imagination, not lifestyle.

05 Is it possible to want something that the system did not, in some way, put there first?

Bernays / Frankfurt / Huxley

Bernays believed it was not. Frankfurt offers a possible exit: if you genuinely endorse a desire on reflection, its causal origin becomes less relevant. Huxley's counter: reflection is also a product of the culture that shaped you.